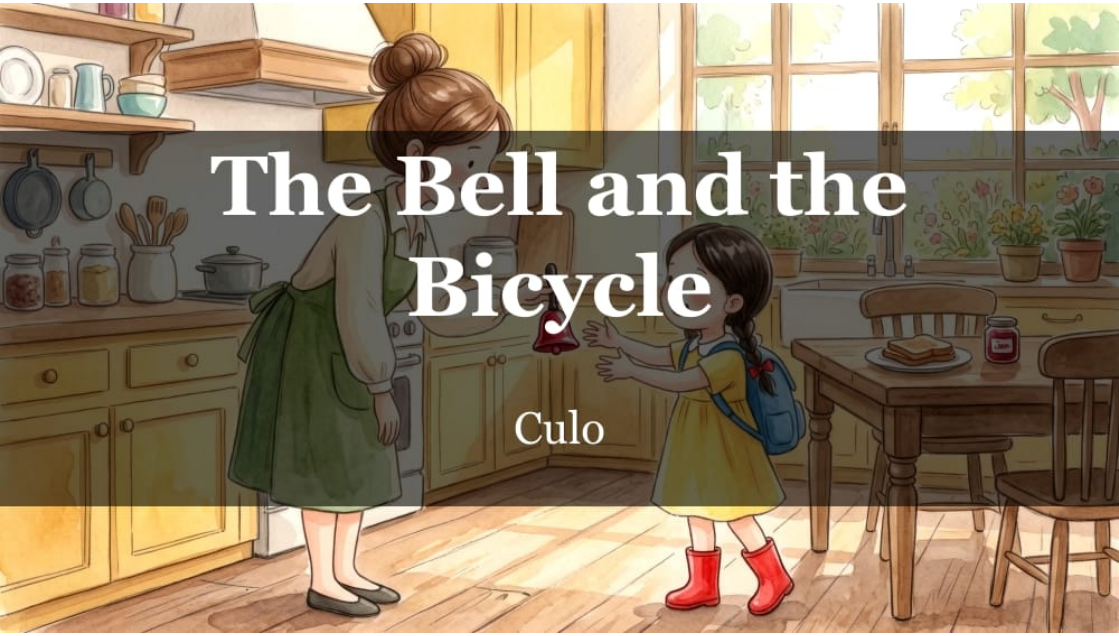


The Bell and the Bicycle

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The Bell and the Bicycle



The bell is small, round and shiny red.

Mama gives it to Lana for her blue bicycle.

Ring-ring, it says when Lana shakes it.



Lana turns the little screw tight.

She rings it. Ring-ring!

The blue bicycle is ready.



Kiki wags her tail so fast it makes a little wind.

Lana rides up and rings her bell. Ring-ring!



They ride along the winding path. Ring-ring!

Kiki runs after them, paws going pat-pat.

The bell rings and rings all morning.



The front wheel bumps a big root. Bump!

The red bell pops off and rolls away into the grass.

Lana and Tomo look at the empty handlebar.



They look under the red bench. No bell.

They look in the grass and by the pond.

The ducks watch with round eyes.



Kiki sniffs the leaves. Sniff, sniff, sniff.

She digs and digs, and the leaves fly up like little birds.

Lana and Tomo lean in close.



Kiki trots out with something in her mouth.

It is the red bell! Muddy, but whole.

The children cheer. Kiki wags her whole back end.



Lana wipes the bell on her sleeve until the red shines again.

She rings it. Ring-ring!

Tomo laughs, and Kiki barks one happy bark.



The sun turns gold and the shadows grow long.

They ride home slowly, and the bell rings all the way. Ring-ring, ring-ring.



Mama asks about the ride.

Lana rings the bell for her. Ring-ring!

Mama smiles. It sounds like a good day.



The red bell sits on the nightstand, shiny and quiet.

Lana is asleep, and Kiki curls at her feet.

Goodnight, bell. Goodnight, ring-ring.